

9. (a) In 2018–19, there was an outbreak of the Ebola virus disease in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC). A double-blind clinical trial was carried out in four villages on 499 people infected with the Ebola virus. The purpose was to test the effectiveness of four potential treatments against the virus.

Table 9 shows the results halfway through the trial in August 2019.

Table 9

Treatment	Percentage of infected people dying from Ebola following the treatment (%)
REGN-EB3	29
mAb-114	33
ZMapp	49
Remdesivir	53

At the time of the trial, 1900 people out of 2831 confirmed cases of Ebola in other parts of the DRC had died of the disease. None of the 2831 people were part of the trial and so did not receive any of the four treatments above.

- (i) Use the information given above to calculate the percentage of confirmed cases of Ebola who received no treatment and died of the disease. **Give your answer to two significant figures.** [2]

Percentage =

- (ii) The results shown in **Table 9** convinced the scientists to stop using ZMapp and Remdesivir, and place all remaining patients on either REGN-EB3 or mAb-114.

Suggest why the scientists stopped using ZMapp and Remdesivir in August 2019 and placed all the remaining patients on either REGN-EB3 or mAb-114. [1]

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- (iii) Explain the meaning and importance of double-blind trials. [2]

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